

CELL PHONES

Cellphones are a product category which sees constant upheaval as new models are continuously pushed towards market; and product lines are refreshed every three months or so. This year has seen the entry of several lower-priced PDA cellphones in the market giving users with smaller budgets the chance to dabble with higher-end phones that were previously unaffordable. Smartphones have also trickled down to the masses and cameras, good screens and decent music capabilities are now available at previously unheard of prices. This year also marks the entry of GPS into cellphones as a much coveted feature; irrespective of its usage. We've also seen the entry of a large number of three plus megapixel head-phones in the market and at very competitive and sensible price points.

Cell Phones Up To Rs 8,000

REIGNING CHAMPION (BEST BUY)
LG KG195

LG's little KG195 impressed us with its set of features for the price. With solid build quality, a camera and memory expansion along with a decent colour screen this phone is priced at Rs 3,990. For someone looking for something on a shoestring budget this is it.



LG KG195



BEST PERFORMER
Nokia N95 8 GB

Nokia's previous generation flagship is just the best phone around. Although Nokia has gone ahead with the N96 we figure they've missed out on a trick or two, particularly with the performance of the music player and the phone's battery life. The fact that the N95 8 GB also has a faster processor than its successor is also of importance to quite a few people. The N95 8 GB remains one of those few devices that approached being perfect in most ways.

CHALLENGER(S)
None

AND THE WINNER IS
LG KG195

LG has a winner that is unbeatable for its ratio of features to value for money. To add to its value it's a good cellphone with decent signal quality and a good keypad. At this price point we could not find anything better.

Cell Phones Between Rs 8,001 And Rs 15,000

REIGNING CHAMPION (BEST BUY)
Sony Ericsson W380

Sony Ericsson's W380 is a solid multimedia phone at a superb price point. For starters it's

super cute with jazzy colours and a nice solid feeling clamshell form factor. The second display is embedded in the fibre body which we discovered is actually translucent. With a very decent display, 1.3 megapixel camera, memory expansion and immeasurable style the W380 was our best buy in this category.

CHALLENGER(S)
None



AND THE WINNER IS
Sony Ericsson's W380 walks away with our Zero1 award. A superb looking phone designed to appeal to both sexes that's reasonably feature rich as well.

Cell Phones Above Rs 20,000

REIGNING CHAMPION
Samsung U900

The U900 also known as the *Soul* is a beautiful cellphone. Its slider is ultra slick, the backlit touch buttons work flawlessly and it is superbly well-built phone to boot. The keypad is nice and spaced out; and the shortcut buttons well placed. The fact that the phone has a very funky backlit feather touch menu buttons are just a novelty. Samsung has dropped in a very clear and crisp screen; in addition to this the five megapixel camera and great sound quality is something everyone will like. Priced at Rs 20,000 this phone is just right for the features it offers.



CHALLENGER(S)
Nokia N85

The Nokia N85 is the latest from their N8x series. An OLED screen which is a first from Nokia for their high-end phones should help with battery life as well. This phone looks very neat and is solidly built. A heavy duty 1200 mAh battery provides good talk time while connectivity options like WLAN and Bluetooth along with A-GPS support mean you're well covered for any usage pattern.

Oh, and it's a double slider as well; which is a rarity and grants additional flaunt value. The only possible minus is the slightly steep price of Rs 27,299; however this is to be expected from such a feature-rich phone.

AND THE WINNER IS
Samsung U900s

For its flaunt value, sheer usability, excellently laidout keypad and the heavy duty, slick slider Samsungs U900 is unbeatable for the price. It's a feature-rich phone that's built to last; and it is our choice for a high-end smartphone.

